



OpenLDAP

for User Authentication

In the last article, we created an openLDAP-based address book with basic data. In this article, we will focus on Centralised Network Authentication—a basic requirement of the networked world. Modern-day users centrally authenticate to a plethora of services that range from Web e-mail service providers and office desktop passwords to ticket-booking sites for travel, entertainment, etc. Most of these sites and office servers save at least the username/password attributes in a centralised directory. In this article, we will configure Linux clients for authentication through a centralised directory.

The address book we created in the last article (see *LINUX For You*, June 2010) can be extended to include various attributes,

such as photograph, date of birth, home address, work address and many more, if required. For customised requirements, we can create our own objectClasses and attributes, but generally